

LESSON 9

Commands and Intentions

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–8

Before diving into new material, take a moment to consolidate what you have learned so far. Lessons 1–8 have introduced you to the following foundational topics:

- **Lesson 0:** The Estrangela alphabet
- **Lesson 1:** Noun states, independent pronouns, verbless clauses, and the particles *d-* and *l-*
- **Lesson 2:** The Peal active participle with enclitic pronouns (the narrative present)
- **Lesson 3:** The Peal perfect (*qṭal*) — all persons and numbers; V-S-O word order
- **Lesson 4:** Pronominal suffixes on nouns and prepositions; *ʾit l-* (“to have”)
- **Lesson 5:** The Aphel stem — causation
- **Lesson 6:** The Paael stem — intensive and factitive meaning
- **Lesson 7:** Weak roots: I-Alaph, I-Yodh, and III-Yodh verbs
- **Lesson 8:** The Peal imperfect (*neqṭol*): the future, and *d-* + imperfect for purpose

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer each question from memory before checking against your notes. Write your answer in full Syriac script with transliteration.

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	What is the Peal perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>k-t-b</i> (write)?	<i>ktab</i> — he wrote	ܠܝܬܒ
2	What is the Peal imperfect 3 m.sg. of <i>š-m-ʿ</i> (hear)?	<i>nešmaʿ</i> — he will hear	ܬܫܡܥ
3	How do you say “the king commanded” (<i>p-q-d</i> , 3 m.sg. perfect)?	<i>pqad malkā</i> — the king commanded	ܩܕܡܠܟܐ
4	What does the Paael stem add to the root’s meaning?	Intensity, repetition, or a denominative meaning	—
5	Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>n-p-q</i> (go out).	<i>ʿappeq</i> — he brought out / caused to go out	ܥܦܩ

SECTION 2: THE IMPERATIVE

2.1 What Is the Imperative?

The imperative is the grammatical form used to issue **direct commands** or requests addressed to a second person (“you”). In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the imperative exists only in the second person — singular and plural, masculine and feminine. There is no first-person or third-person imperative; those ideas are expressed by other means (the cohortative and the jussive).

The **formation** of the Peal imperative follows a straightforward rule: take the **imperfect form**, strip away the **t-** prefix of the 2nd person, and you have the imperative. The vowel pattern is then **CCoC** for the masculine singular (e.g., *ktob* “write!”). This parallels the Hebrew Qal imperative (כתב ktōv) and the Arabic imperative (اكتب uktub), though the exact vowel patterns differ.

2.2 Peal Imperative — Formation

Masculine Singular: **CCoC** — the simplest form, the bare root with the characteristic o-vowel. E.g., **ktob** ܠܝܬܒ “Write! (to one man)”

Feminine Singular: **CCoC + -ī** — add the feminine marker ī. E.g., **ktobī** ܠܝܬܒܝ “Write! (to one woman)”

Masculine Plural: *CCoC + -w* — add the masculine plural ending. E.g., **ktobw** כתוב “Write! (to a group of men)”

Feminine Plural: *CCoC + -ān* — add the feminine plural ending. E.g., **ktobān** כתוב “Write! (to a group of women)”

2.3 Complete Paradigm Tables

Root k-t-b כתב (write)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg (m. sg.)	כתוב ktob	Write! (to one man)	e man)
2fsg (f. sg.)	כתובי ktobī	Write! (to one woman)	e woman)
2mpl (m. pl.)	כתובו ktobw	Write! (to a group of men)	group of men)
2fpl (f. pl.)	כתובנה ktobān	Write! (to a group of women)	group of women)

Root š-m-‘ שמע (hear)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg	שמע šma ‘	Hear! (to one man)	man)
2fsg	שמעי šma ‘ ī	Hear! (to one woman)	woman)
2mpl	שמעו šma ‘ w	Hear! (to a group of men)	roup of men)
2fpl	שמענה šma ‘ ān	Hear! (to a group of women)	roup of women)

2.4 Derived Stems: Pael and Aphel Imperatives

Pael Imperative: The Pael intensifies or extends the root meaning. Its imperative is built from the Pael imperfect. The form is **mCaCC-e** (msg) — note the characteristic doubled middle radical. E.g., **bārek** בָּרַךְ “Bless! / Praise!”; **‘allep** אָלַץ “Teach!”

Aphel Imperative: The Aphel is causative. Its imperative begins with **’a-**. E.g., **’appaq** אֶפְקֹ “Bring out!”; **’ahwī** אֶחְוֵ “Show!”

2.5 Negative Commands

Key Rule: Negating Commands

In Syriac, negative commands (prohibitions) are NOT formed with the imperative.

Instead, use: lā + IMPERFECT (2nd person).

This is identical to Biblical Hebrew (לֹא + jussive / יִשְׁמַע + imperfect) and Arabic (لا + mudāri ‘).

Example: lā tektob ܠܐ ܬܬܝܒ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not write!” (lit. “you-shall-not write”)

Example: lā tešma ‘ ܠܐ ܬܫܡܥ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not listen!”

2.6 Cross-Linguistic Comparison

Students coming from different language backgrounds will find useful parallels:

LANGUAGE	FORM (WRITE!)	FORM (HEAR!)	NEGATIVE	NOTES
Syriac	ktob ܬܬܝܒ	šma ‘ ܬܫܡܥ	lā + imperfect	2nd person only; 4 forms (g/n)
Hebrew	ktōv ܬܬܝܒ	šma ‘ ܬܫܡܥ	לֹא + jussive	Similar 4-form paradigm
Arabic	uktub ܬܬܝܒ	isma ‘ ܬܫܡܥ	لا + imperfect	Form I imperative derived from imperfect
Greek	γράφει / γράψον	ἀκούει / ἀκούσον	μή + subjunctive	Pres./Aor. distinction; no gender
Latin	scribe	audi	noli + infinitive	4th conjugation; no gender marking

2.7 Example Commands with Interlinear Gloss

Study each command carefully. The word-by-word gloss is given directly below the Syriac.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܕܠܝܡܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ	ktob šmeh d-malkā* w of-the.king	rite! name-his W the king!	rite the name of
ܫܡܐ ܕܩܠܝܐ	šma' qālī* h	ear! voice-my H	ear my voice!
ܐܝܢܐ ܕܝܢܐ	haww yāḏ' īn* b	e-pl. knowing K [m.pl.]	now (be knowing)!
ܠܐ ܬܕܗܠ	lā tedḥal* n	ot you-fear D	o not be afraid!
ܐܝܠܐ ܕܐܝܠܐ	'ezlaw w-emraw* g say-pl.!	o-pl.! and G [m.pl.]	o and tell!
ܐܝܠܐ ܕܐܝܠܐ	'aḥwāynī 'attā* s	how-me! sign S	how me a sign!

SECTION 3: THE INFINITIVE (VERBAL NOUN / MAŠḌAR)

3.1 The Nature of the Syriac Infinitive

Syriac, like Arabic and Hebrew, possesses a **verbal noun** — a noun derived from the verb root that expresses the action in abstract form. In Arabic this is called the **maṣḍar** (مصدر, “source”). In Hebrew it corresponds to the **infinitive construct**. In Syriac it functions similarly and is often called the **infinitive** in grammars. It can serve as the subject of a sentence, the object of a verb, or — most commonly in narrative — as a **complementary infinitive** after a modal or semi-modal verb, introduced by the preposition ܠ- (“to”).

3.2 Infinitive Formation by Stem

Peal Infinitive: meCCaC pattern. Insert me- prefix and reduce the stem. E.g., k-t-b → **mektab** ܡܚܬܒ ‘the writing / to write’. Root š-m-ʿ → **mešmaʿ** ܡܫܡܥ ‘the hearing’.

Paael Infinitive: mCaCCāCū — m- prefix, doubled middle radical, ā before the last radical, final ū. E.g., barrek (bless, Paael) → **mbarrākū** ܡܒܪܪܐܟܘܢ ‘the blessing’.

Aphel Infinitive: maCCāCū — ma- prefix with ā-vowel before final radical + ū. E.g., ʿappeq (bring out, Aphel) → **mappāqū** ܡܦܦܩܘܢ ‘to bring out’.

3.3 Infinitive Forms — Five Key Verbs

ROOT	MEANING	PEAL INF.	PAAEL INF.	APHEL INF.
k-t-b	write mektab כתב	mkatābū כתבו	'aktābū כתבו	
š-m-ʿ	hear mešma שמע	mšamā' ū שמעו	'ašmā' ū שמעו	
q-ṭ-l	kill meqṭal חמץ	mqaṭālū חמץ	'aqṭālū חמץ	
p-q-d	command mepqad מצוה	mpaqādū מצוה	'apqādū מצוה	
y-d-ʿ	know mīda ידע	myādā' ū ידעו	'awdā' ū ידעו	

3.4 The Critical Construction: l- + Infinitive

The l- + Infinitive Construction

PATTERN: MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE

This construction expresses purpose or complement: 'he began to write', 'she is able to hear'.

The preposition l- is prefixed directly to the infinitive with no space.

Compare: Greek + infinitive (γράφειν); Latin accusative + infinitive (scribere); Arabic أن + imperfect.

In Hebrew the parallel is the lamed + infinitive construct: לכתוב (liktōv).

Eight Example Sentences with l- + Infinitive:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܫܪܝܠܡܟܬܒ * ܒ	šarī l-mektab* b	egan to.write H	e began to write.
ܝܐܟܠܠܡܫܡܐ * ܝ	yākel l-mešma ' * i	s.able to.hear H	e is able to hear.
ܒܐܝܠܡܡܐ * ܠܡܝܠܐ	bā ' ē l-me ' zal* w	ants to.go H	e wants to go.
ܫܒܐܠܡܥܬܐ * ܠܡܩܬܐ	šābē l-meqṭal* w	ishes to.kill H	e wishes to kill.
ܦܩܕܠܡܥܝܪܐ * ܥܝܪܐ	paqed l-me ' sar* c to.bind	ommanded H to bind.	e commanded (them)
ܫܕܪܠܡܥܒܕܐ * ܫܕܪܐ	šadar l-me ' bad* s	ent to.do/make H act.	e sent (them) to
ܠܐܝܐܟܠܠܡܥܝܠܐ * ܠܡܥܝܠܐ	lā yākel l-me ' zal* n to.go	ot is.able H go.	e is not able to
ܫܪܝܬܠܡܥܪܐ * ܡܠܬܐ	šarīt l-meqrā maltā* y to.read	ou.began Y the word. word.the	ou began to read

SECTION 4: VERBS OF BEGINNING, ABILITY, AND DESIRE

4.1 Semi-Modal Verbs

These verbs function like **modal auxiliaries** in English and govern an infinitive complement introduced by **l-**. They are extremely common in Syriac narrative. Master these verbs and their paradigms, as they appear repeatedly in the Acts of Mar Yukhannan.

š-r-y, 𐰽 — begin

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šarī , 𐤑𐤕𐤓

Example: שָׂרִי לִמְכַתֵּב, *šarī l-mektab* — He began to write.

Note: Very common in narrative openings. Note final yod (weak root š-r-y).

y-k-l **حَدَّ** — be able / can

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: yākel **حَدَّ**

Example: يَاكُلُ الْمِيتَةَ *yākel l-meqtal* — He is able to kill.

Note: The Syriac equivalent of Greek δύναμις, Latin possum. Often negated: lā yākel.

b-ʿ -y ܒܥ — want / seek / ask

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: bā ʿ ē ܒܥ

Example: ܒܥ ܠܡܥܠ bā ʿ ē l-me ʿzal — He wants to go.

Note: Can also mean ‘ask’ or ‘pray’. Third-aleph weak root.

ṣ-b-y ܒܥܝ — wish / will / be pleased

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: ṣābē ܒܥܝ

Example: ܒܥܝ ܠܡܥܬܐ ṣābē l-meqtal — He wishes to kill.

Note: Related noun ṣebyānā (will/wish) is key theological vocabulary.

p-q-d ܦܩܕ — command / order

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: paqed ܦܩܕ

Example: ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥܬܐ paqed l-me ʿsar — He commanded to bind (him).

Note: Often takes a direct object (the recipient of the order) + l- + infinitive.

š-d-r ܫܕܪ — send

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šadar ܫܕܪ

Example: ܫܕܪ ܠܡܥܬܐ šadar ʿenāšē l-meqtal — He sent men to kill.

Note: The l-+infinitive here expresses purpose: ‘sent in order to kill’.

SECTION 5: MILITARY AND EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS

This vocabulary set is essential for the narrative of Lesson 9. Many of these words appear in the story and

exercises. Learn both the verbal root and its noun/adjective derivatives.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>m-ḥ-y</i>	ܡܚܝ <i>mḥā / nemḥē</i>	strike, smite	, hit
<i>d-ḥ-l</i>	ܕܚܠ *dḥel / nedḥa	l* fear, be afra	id
<i>ḥ-d-y</i>	ܚܕܝ <i>ḥdī / neḥdē</i>	rejoice, be g	lad
<i>’-s-r</i>	ܫܪܐ *’asar / ne’ s	or* bind, tie, im	prison
<i>š-r-y</i>	ܫܪܝ <i>šrā / nešrē</i>	loosen, relea	se, begin
<i>r-m-y</i>	ܪܡܝ <i>rmā / nerme</i>	throw, cast	
<i>’-ḥ-d</i>	ܚܕܐ *’ḥad / ne’ ḥo	d* seize, grab,	take hold
<i>g-r-r</i>	ܓܪܪ *grār / negro	r* drag, pull	
<i>’-r-q</i>	ܪܩܐ *’raq / ne’ ro	q* flee, escape	
<i>r-d-p</i>	ܪܕܦ *rdap / nerdo	p* pursue, chase	, persecute
<i>q-ṭ-l</i>	ܩܬܠ *qṭal / neqṭo	l* kill, slay	
<i>p-ṣ-’</i>	ܦܨܐ *pṣā’ / nepsa	’ * wound, injure	
<i>z-’-q</i>	ܙܥܩ *z’aq / nez’ o	q* cry out, shou	t
<i>p-q-d</i>	ܦܩܕ *pqad / nepqo	d* command, orde	r
<i>k-n-š</i>	ܟܢܫ *knaš / neksn	oš* gather, assem	ble
<i>estrātyōṭā</i>	ܐܫܬܪܬܝܘܬܐ <i>estrātyōṭā</i>	soldier (Gree	k loanword: στρατιώτης)
<i>ḥaylā</i>	ܚܐܠܐ <i>ḥaylā</i>	army; strengt	h, power (dual meaning)
<i>saypā</i>	ܣܝܦܐ <i>saypā</i>	sword	
<i>nūrā</i>	ܢܘܪܐ <i>nūrā</i>	fire	
<i>’attūnā</i>	ܐܬܘܢܐ *’attūnā	furnace, oven	
<i>šalšaltā</i>	ܫܠܫܠܬܐ <i>šalšaltā</i>	chain (relate	d to Heb. שְׁלִישׁ)
<i>gūbbā</i>	ܓܘܒܒܐ <i>gūbbā</i>	pit, cistern;	den (as in lion’s den)
<i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	ܒܝܬܐ ܕܥܝܪܐ <i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	prison (lit.	‘house of the bound ones’)
<i>kansā</i>	ܟܢܨܐ <i>kansā</i>	crowd, gather	ing, assembly

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>qālā</i>	קָלָא <i>qālā</i>	voice, sound	
<i>rugzā</i>	רָגַז <i>rugzā</i>	anger, wrath	
<i>dehltā</i>	דִּהַלְתָּ <i>dehltā</i>	fear (noun; f	rom d-h-l)
<i>'ammīnūttā</i>	אֲמִינֻתָּא <i>'ammīnūttā</i>	steadfastness	, courage, endurance
<i>pūqdānā</i>	פִּקְדָּנָא <i>pūqdānā</i>	command, comm	andment (noun from p-q-d)
<i>ṣebyānā</i>	שְׂבִינָא <i>ṣebyānā</i>	will, wish, d	esire (key theological term)

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 9

The King Commands: Seize Yukhannan

The narrative reaches a climax. Having heard reports of Yukhannan's preaching and miracles, the king summons his soldiers and issues a series of direct commands. The passage is rich in imperatives and *l-* + infinitive constructions, giving you immediate practice in the new grammar.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܢ ܕܐ ܫܡܐ ܕܬ ܡܠܠܐ ܗܠܐܢ	malkā den kad šma ‘ t he.heard wor	he.king now when N ds these heard these	ow when the king words,
ܐܬܡܠܝ ܒܪܘܓܝܐ ܗܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܩܠܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܩܠܐ	’etmalī b-rugzā h ā rabbā* with-anger	e.was.filled h anger and cr and-he.cried.out with- voice great	e was filled with ied out with a great voice.
ܠܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܣܬܪܐܬܝܘܬܐ	paqed h w(hy)* to- his.soldi	e.commanded H ers soldiers,	e commanded his
ܠܝܫܐܢܐ ܕܝܫܐܢܐ ܕܝܫܐܢܐ ܝܫܐܢܐ ܕܝܫܐܢܐ	’ezlaw w- ’eḥodw g Yukhannan (ob	o.pl! and seize.pl! ” j.) Yukhannan!	Go and seize
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	w- ’atīw w- ’armōhy a and-throw.hi	nd-come.pl! C m! into the fur in-the.furnace	ome and throw him nace!
ܠܐܬܬܐܘܠܡܢ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܐܬܬܐܘܠܡܢ ܠܐܬܬܐܘܠܡܢ	lā tedḥlūn men n signs- his	ot you.fear.pl from D signs!”	o not fear his
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	estrāṭyōṭē šarīw s to.go l-me ’zal	oldiers they.began T to go.	he soldiers began
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	bā ‘ ē ḥad mennhon w to.turn.back	anted one from-them O to turn back	ne of them wanted .
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	’emar: lā yākelnan h dīqā* we.are.able	e.said not H to.kill not able to righteous.man	e said: ‘We are kill a righteous man.’
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	’aḥrānē ’asrw o šalšaltā* hands-his wi	thers they.bound O th- chain hands with a	thers bound his chain.
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	w-grarwōhy lawāt a toward furna	nd-they.dragged.him A ce him toward t	nd they dragged he furnace.
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܢܐ	Yūḥannan dēn lā Yu allī* dhāl ’ellā ṣ	khannan but not Bu t not fear; in he.prayed	t Yukhannan did stead he prayed.

Smooth English Translation:

Now when the king heard these words, he was filled with anger and cried out with a great voice. He commanded his soldiers: “Go and seize Yukhannan! Come and throw him into the furnace! Do not fear his signs!” The soldiers began

to go. One of them wanted to turn back. He said: “We are not able to kill a righteous man.” Others bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace. But Yukhannan did not fear; instead he prayed.

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

Write out all four imperative forms (msg, fsg, mpl, fpl) for each of the following roots in the Peal stem. Include Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. ' -z-l (go) — Peal imperfect 2msg: tēzal → imperative: ?
2. ' -b-d (do, make) — Peal imperfect 2msg: te ' bod → imperative: ?
3. q-r- ' (read, call) — Peal imperfect 2msg: teqrā → imperative: ?

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation

Form the Peal, Paael, and Aphel infinitives for each root. Use the pattern: Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCaCCāCū; Aphel = maCCāCū.

4. n-p-q (go out)
5. q-b-l (receive)
6. š-d-r (send)
7. ḥ-z-y (see)
8. ' -l-l (enter)
9. y-l-d (give birth)
10. r-ḥ-m (have mercy)
11. s-g-d (worship)

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into English. Identify any imperatives and l-+infinitive constructions.

12. ܡܠܟܐ ܕܝܫܘܥ ܕܝܫܘܥ

13. ܐܡܪ ܡܠܟ ܕܐܠܡܐ

14. ܠܐ ܬܪܝܬܝܐ

15. ܐܝܬܝܠܡܢܐ ܫܚܝܬܐ

16. ܫܠܡܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܚܝܐ ܕܐܡܐ

17. ܫܠܡܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܚܝܐ ܕܐܡܐ

18. ܦܪܥܝܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܚܝܐ ܕܐܡܐ

19. ܫܠܡܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Express each sentence in Syriac. Use Estrangela script and transliteration.

20. Hear me, O king! (m.sg.)

21. Do not kill the righteous man! (m.pl.)

22. He began to pray.

23. The soldier is not able to flee.

24. The king commanded to throw him into the furnace.

25. She wants to read the book.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6 and answer the following questions in English.

26. Why did the king fill with anger?

27. What two commands did the king give his soldiers?

28. What did one soldier say? Why was he reluctant?

29. How was Yukhannan restrained before being brought to the furnace?

30. How did Yukhannan respond to his situation?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

'-z-l (go):

- msg: 'ezal עזאל
- fsg: 'ezlī עזלי
- mpl: 'ezlaw עזלע
- fpl: 'ezlān עזלען

'-b-d (do):

- msg: 'bod בוד
- fsg: 'bodī בודי
- mpl: 'bodw בודע
- fpl: 'bodān בודען

q-r-' (read/call):

- msg: qrī קרי (III-aleph/yod: vowel changes)
- fsg: qrīy קריי
- mpl: qrīw קריע
- fpl: qrīn קריען

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation (selected answers)

n-p-q: Peal mappaq מפקע; Paael mnappāqū מנפקען; Aphel mappāqū מפקע

š-d-r: Peal mešdar משרד; Paael mšadrū משרען; Aphel 'ašdrū משרע

y-l-d: Peal mīlad מליד; Paael myāladū מלידען; Aphel 'auldū מלידע

Exercise 3: Translation

31. Go to Jerusalem!
32. Hear the voice of God! (to a woman)
33. Do not cry out! (m.pl.)
34. He began to read the book.
35. The king wanted to bind Yukhannan.
36. God is able to strike the soldiers.
37. He commanded them to throw (him) into the furnace.
38. Yukhannan wished to pray.

Exercise 4: Production

39. שמעו קול, הנה שמעו, šma ' nī malkā
40. לא תעזבו לאדם צדיק, lā teqṭlūn l-zaddīqā
41. הנה, הנה, šarī l-meṣlā
42. אולי, אולי, אולי, estrāṭyōṭā lā yākel l-me ' raq
43. אולי, אולי, אולי, אולי, paqed malkā l-mermyū leh b- ' attūnā
44. אולי, אולי, אולי, אולי, bā ' yā l-meqrā ketābā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

45. He heard the words (reports) about Yukhannan and was filled with anger.
46. (1) Seize Yukhannan; (2) throw him into the furnace.
47. One soldier said they were not able to kill a righteous man — showing moral hesitation.
48. They bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace.
49. Yukhannan did not fear; he prayed instead.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

The Imperative at a Glance

FORM	ENDING	EXAMPLE (K-T-B)	ESTRANGELA
Masculine Singular	CCoC (bare k stem)	tob ܬܒ	ܬܒܐܬ
Feminine Singular	CCoC + k ī	tobī ܬܒܝ	ܬܒܝܐܬ
Masculine Plural	CCoC + k w	tobw ܬܒܘ	ܬܒܘܐܬ
Feminine Plural	CCoC + k ān	tobān ܬܒܢ	ܬܒܢܐܬ

Infinitive Patterns

STEM	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Peal	meCCaC mektab ܡܝܬܒܐ	Most common;	parallel to Hebrew inf. construct with l-
Paael	mCaCCāCū mbarrākū ܡܒܪܟܐܬܐ	Double middl	e radical characteristic
Aphel	maCCāCū mappāqū ܡܦܩܐܬܐ	'a- prefix as	in the Aphel perfect

The l- + Infinitive Construction

Quick Reference

MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE = 'to [do X]'

šarī l-mektab = He began to write

yākel l-mešma' = He is able to hear

bā' ē l-me' zal = He wants to go

paqed l-me' sar = He commanded to bind

NEGATIVE: lā + IMPERFECT (not imperative!) for prohibitions

The Acts of Mar Yukhannan • Lesson 9: Commands and Intentions • Syriac Language Course

Section 11: Additional Vocabulary

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
קִרְיָה	qirītā	f	village
לִשָּׁן	leššānā	m	tongue, language
עֵצ	garmā	m	bone
סֶלֶסֶל	kēpā	f	stone, rock
מַיָּא	mayyā	m.pl	water
דָּג	nūnā	m	fish
קִרְיָה	mdittā	f	city
שֶׁמֶשׁ	šemšā	m	sun
דֶּלֶת	tar' ā	m	door, gate
שֶׁחַד	mešhā	m	oil